



Access and interpret product information

D2.TTA.CL2.01

Trainer Guide



Access and interpret product information

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Project Base

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The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) was established on 8 August 1967. The Member States of the Association are Brunei Darussalam, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Viet Nam.

The ASEAN Secretariat is based in Jakarta, Indonesia.

General Information on ASEAN appears online at the ASEAN Website: www.asean.org.

All text is produced by William Angliss Institute of TAFE for the ASEAN Project on "Toolbox Development for Travel Agencies and Tour Operations Divisions".

This publication is supported by the Australian Government's aid program through the ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II (AADCP II).

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File name: TG_Access & interpret product info_290415

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Competency Based Training (CBT) and assessment – An introduction for trainers

Competency

Competency refers to the ability to perform particular tasks and duties to the standard of performance expected in the workplace.

Competency requires the application of specified knowledge, skills and attitudes relevant to effective participation, consistently over time and in the workplace environment.

The essential skills and knowledge are either identified separately or combined.

Knowledge identifies what a person needs to know to perform the work in an informed and effective manner.

Skills describe the application of knowledge to situations where understanding is converted into a workplace outcome.

Attitude describes the founding reasons behind the need for certain knowledge or why skills are performed in a specified manner.

Competency covers all aspects of workplace performance and involves:

- Performing individual tasks
- Managing a range of different tasks
- Responding to contingencies or breakdowns
- Dealing with the responsibilities of the workplace
- Working with others.

Unit of competency

Like with any training qualification or program, a range of subject topics are identified that focus on the ability in a certain work area, responsibility or function.

Each manual focuses on a specific unit of competency that applies in the hospitality workplace.

In this manual a unit of competency is identified as a 'unit'.

Each unit of competency identifies a discrete workplace requirement and includes:

- Knowledge and skills that underpin competency
- Language, literacy and numeracy
- Occupational safety and health requirements.

Each unit of competency must be adhered to in training and assessment to ensure consistency of outcomes.

Element of competency

An element of competency describes the essential outcomes within a unit of competency.

The elements of competency are the basic building blocks of the unit of competency. They describe in terms of outcomes the significant functions and tasks that make up the competency.

In this manual elements of competency are identified as an 'element'.

Performance criteria

Performance criteria indicate the standard of performance that is required to demonstrate achievement within an element of competency. The standards reflect identified industry skill needs.

Performance criteria will be made up of certain specified skills, knowledge and attitudes.

Learning

For the purpose of this manual learning incorporates two key activities:

- Training
- Assessment.

Both of these activities will be discussed in detail in this introduction.

Today training and assessment can be delivered in a variety of ways. It may be provided to participants:

- On-the-job – in the workplace
- Off-the-job – at an educational institution or dedicated training environment
- As a combination of these two options.

No longer is it necessary for learners to be absent from the workplace for long periods of time in order to obtain recognised and accredited qualifications.

Learning approaches

This manual will identify two avenues to facilitate learning:

Competency Based Training (CBT)

This is the strategy of developing a participant's competency.

Educational institutions utilise a range of training strategies to ensure that participants are able to gain the knowledge and skills required for successful:

- Completion of the training program or qualification
- Implementation in the workplace.

The strategies selected should be chosen based on suitability and the learning styles of participants.

Competency Based Assessment (CBA)

This is the strategy of assessing competency of a participant.

Educational institutions utilise a range of assessment strategies to ensure that participants are assessed in a manner that demonstrates validity, fairness, reliability, flexibility and fairness of assessment processes.

Flexibility in learning

It is important to note that flexibility in training and assessment strategies is required to meet the needs of participants who may have learning difficulties. The strategies used will vary, taking into account the needs of individual participants with learning difficulties. However they will be applied in a manner which does not discriminate against the participant or the participant body as a whole.

Catering for participant diversity

Participants have diverse backgrounds, needs and interests. When planning training and assessment activities to cater for individual differences, trainers and assessors should:

- Consider individuals' experiences, learning styles and interests
- Develop questions and activities that are aimed at different levels of ability
- Modify the expectations for some participants
- Provide opportunities for a variety of forms of participation, such as individual, pair and small group activities
- Assess participants based on individual progress and outcomes.

The diversity among participants also provides a good reason for building up a learning community in which participants support each other's learning.

Participant centred learning

This involves taking into account structuring training and assessment that:

- *Builds on strengths* – Training environments need to demonstrate the many positive features of local participants (such as the attribution of academic success to effort, and the social nature of achievement motivation) and of their trainers (such as a strong emphasis on subject disciplines and moral responsibility). These strengths and uniqueness of local participants and trainers should be acknowledged and treasured
- *Acknowledges prior knowledge and experience* – The learning activities should be planned with participants' prior knowledge and experience in mind
- *Understands learning objectives* – Each learning activity should have clear learning objectives and participants should be informed of them at the outset. Trainers should also be clear about the purpose of assignments and explain their significance to participants
- *Teaches for understanding* – The pedagogies chosen should aim at enabling participants to act and think flexibly with what they know
- *Teaches for independent learning* – Generic skills and reflection should be nurtured through learning activities in appropriate contexts of the curriculum. Participants should be encouraged to take responsibility for their own learning

- *Enhances motivation* – Learning is most effective when participants are motivated. Various strategies should be used to arouse the interest of participants
- *Makes effective use of resources* – A variety of teaching resources can be employed as tools for learning
- *Maximises engagement* – In conducting learning activities, it is important for the minds of participants to be actively engaged
- *Aligns assessment with learning and teaching* – Feedback and assessment should be an integral part of learning and teaching
- *Caters for learner diversity* – Trainers should be aware that participants have different characteristics and strengths and try to nurture these rather than impose a standard set of expectations.

Active learning

The goal of nurturing independent learning in participants does not imply that they always have to work in isolation or solely in a classroom. On the contrary, the construction of knowledge in tourism and hospitality studies can often best be carried out in collaboration with others in the field. Sharing experiences, insights and views on issues of common concern, and working together to collect information through conducting investigative studies in the field (active learning) can contribute a lot to their eventual success.

Active learning has an important part to play in fostering a sense of community in the class. First, to operate successfully, a learning community requires an ethos of acceptance and a sense of trust among participants, and between them and their trainers. Trainers can help to foster acceptance and trust through encouragement and personal example, and by allowing participants to take risks as they explore and articulate their views, however immature these may appear to be. Participants also come to realise that their classmates (and their trainers) are partners in learning and solving.

Trainers can also encourage cooperative learning by designing appropriate group learning tasks, which include, for example, collecting background information, conducting small-scale surveys, or producing media presentations on certain issues and themes. Participants need to be reminded that, while they should work towards successful completion of the field tasks, developing positive peer relationships in the process is an important objective of all group work.

Competency Based Training (CBT)

Principle of Competency Based Training

Competency based training is aimed at developing the knowledge, skills and attitudes of participants, through a variety of training tools.

Training strategies

The aims of this curriculum are to enable participants to:

- Undertake a variety of subject courses that are relevant to industry in the current environment
- Learn current industry skills, information and trends relevant to industry
- Learn through a range of practical and theoretical approaches
- Be able to identify, explore and solve issues in a productive manner

- Be able to become confident, equipped and flexible managers of the future
- Be 'job ready' and a valuable employee in the industry upon graduation of any qualification level.

To ensure participants are able to gain the knowledge and skills required to meet competency in each unit of competency in the qualification, a range of training delivery modes are used.

Types of training

In choosing learning and teaching strategies, trainers should take into account the practical, complex and multi-disciplinary nature of the subject area, as well as their participant's prior knowledge, learning styles and abilities.

Training outcomes can be attained by utilising one or more delivery methods:

Lecture/tutorial

This is a common method of training involving transfer of information from the trainer to the participants. It is an effective approach to introduce new concepts or information to the learners and also to build upon the existing knowledge. The listener is expected to reflect on the subject and seek clarifications on the doubts.

Demonstration

Demonstration is a very effective training method that involves a trainer showing a participant how to perform a task or activity. Through a visual demonstration, trainers may also explain reasoning behind certain actions or provide supplementary information to help facilitate understanding.

Group discussions

Brainstorming in which all the members in a group express their ideas, views and opinions on a given topic. It is a free flow and exchange of knowledge among the participants and the trainer. The discussion is carried out by the group on the basis of their own experience, perceptions and values. This will facilitate acquiring new knowledge. When everybody is expected to participate in the group discussion, even the introverted persons will also get stimulated and try to articulate their feelings.

The ideas that emerge in the discussions should be noted down and presentations are to be made by the groups. Sometimes consensus needs to be arrived at on a given topic. Group discussions are to be held under the moderation of a leader guided by the trainer. Group discussion technique triggers thinking process, encourages interactions and enhances communication skills.

Role play

This is a common and very effective method of bringing into the classroom real life situations, which may not otherwise be possible. Participants are made to enact a particular role so as to give a real feel of the roles they may be called upon to play. This enables participants to understand the behaviour of others as well as their own emotions and feelings. The instructor must brief the role players on what is expected of them. The role player may either be given a ready-made script, which they can memorise and enact, or they may be required to develop their own scripts around a given situation. This technique is extremely useful in understanding creative selling techniques and human relations. It can be entertaining and energising and it helps the reserved and less literate to express their feelings.

Simulation games

When trainees need to become aware of something that they have not been conscious of, simulations can be a useful mechanism. Simulation games are a method based on "here and now" experience shared by all the participants. The games focus on the participation of the trainees and their willingness to share their ideas with others. A "near real life" situation is created providing an opportunity to which they apply themselves by adopting certain behaviour. They then experience the impact of their behaviour on the situation. It is carried out to generate responses and reactions based on the real feelings of the participants, which are subsequently analysed by the trainer.

While use of simulation games can result in very effective learning, it needs considerable trainer competence to analyse the situations.

Individual /group exercises

Exercises are often introduced to find out how much the participant has assimilated. This method involves imparting instructions to participants on a particular subject through use of written exercises. In the group exercises, the entire class is divided into small groups, and members are asked to collaborate to arrive at a consensus or solution to a problem.

Case study

This is a training method that enables the trainer and the participant to experience a real life situation. It may be on account of events in the past or situations in the present, in which there may be one or more problems to be solved and decisions to be taken. The basic objective of a case study is to help participants diagnose, analyse and/or solve a particular problem and to make them internalise the critical inputs delivered in the training. Questions are generally given at the end of the case study to direct the participants and to stimulate their thinking towards possible solutions. Studies may be presented in written or verbal form.

Field visit

This involves a carefully planned visit or tour to a place of learning or interest. The idea is to give first-hand knowledge by personal observation of field situations, and to relate theory with practice. The emphasis is on observing, exploring, asking questions and understanding. The trainer should remember to brief the participants about what they should observe and about the customs and norms that need to be respected.

Group presentation

The participants are asked to work in groups and produce the results and findings of their group work to the members of another sub-group. By this method participants get a good picture of each other's views and perceptions on the topic and they are able to compare them with their own point of view. The pooling and sharing of findings enriches the discussion and learning process.

Practice sessions

This method is of paramount importance for skills training. Participants are provided with an opportunity to practice in a controlled situation what they have learnt. It could be real life or through a make-believe situation.

Games

This is a group process and includes those methods that involve usually fun-based activity, aimed at conveying feelings and experiences, which are everyday in nature, and applying them within the game being played. A game has set rules and regulations, and may or may not include a competitive element. After the game is played, it is essential that the participants be debriefed and their lessons and experiences consolidated by the trainer.

Research

Trainers may require learners to undertake research activities, including online research, to gather information or further understanding about a specific subject area.

Competency Based Assessment (CBA)

Principle of Competency Based Assessment

Competency based assessment is aimed at compiling a list of evidence that shows that a person is competent in a particular unit of competency.

Competencies are gained through a multitude of ways including:

- Training and development programs
- Formal education
- Life experience
- Apprenticeships
- On-the-job experience
- Self-help programs.

All of these together contribute to job competence in a person. Ultimately, assessors and participants work together, through the 'collection of evidence' in determining overall competence.

This evidence can be collected:

- Using different formats
- Using different people
- Collected over a period of time.

The assessor, who is ideally someone with considerable experience in the area being assessed, reviews the evidence and verifies the person as being competent or not.

Flexibility in assessment

Whilst allocated assessment tools have been identified for this subject, all attempts are made to determine competency and suitable alternate assessment tools may be used, according to the requirements of the participant.

The assessment needs to be equitable for all participants, taking into account their cultural and linguistic needs.

Competency must be proven regardless of:

- Language
- Delivery Method
- Assessment Method.

Assessment objectives

The assessment tools used for subjects are designed to determine competency against the 'elements of competency' and their associated 'performance criteria'.

The assessment tools are used to identify sufficient:

- a) Knowledge, including underpinning knowledge
- b) Skills
- c) Attitudes

Assessment tools are activities that trainees are required to undertake to prove participant competency in this subject.

All assessments must be completed satisfactorily for participants to obtain competence in this subject. There are no exceptions to this requirement, however, it is possible that in some cases several assessment items may be combined and assessed together.

Types of assessment

Allocated Assessment Tools

There are a number of assessment tools that are used to determine competency in this subject:

- Work projects
- Written questions
- Oral questions
- Third Party Report
- Observation Checklist.

Instructions on how assessors should conduct these assessment methods are explained in the Assessment Manuals.

Alternative assessment tools

Whilst this subject has identified assessment tools, as indicated above, this does not restrict the assessor from using different assessment methods to measure the competency of a participant.

Evidence is simply proof that the assessor gathers to show participants can actually do what they are required to do.

Whilst there is a distinct requirement for participants to demonstrate competency, there are many and diverse sources of evidence available to the assessor.

Ongoing performance at work, as verified by a supervisor or physical evidence, can count towards assessment. Additionally, the assessor can talk to customers or work colleagues to gather evidence about performance.

A range of assessment methods to assess competency include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals: slides, audio tapes
- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects
- Role plays
- Group projects
- Group discussions
- Examinations.

Recognition of Prior Learning

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

Also known as a Skills Recognition Audit (SRA), this process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Assessing competency

As mentioned, assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency. Traditionally in education, grades or marks were given to participants, dependent on how many questions the participant successfully answered in an assessment tool.

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- Pass Competent (PC)
- Not Yet Competent (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: ACCESS AND INTERPRET PRODUCT INFORMATION		NOMINAL HOURS: 80
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTA.CL2.01		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to access and explain domestic and/or internal tourism-specific information to support sales activities.		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA	UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE	
Element 1: Identify and evaluate sources of product information 1.1 List potential <i>sources of product information</i> 1.2 <i>Determine usefulness</i> of product information sources 1.3 Identify <i>items that may contain product information</i> Element 2: Access product information 2.1 Select appropriate sources of product information 2.2 <i>Register</i> to receive and/or access product information 2.3 Visit suppliers and other sources to talk with sales staff and obtain items that may contain product information	Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment. This unit applies to work in the travel industry within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Sources of product information</i> may relate to: • Internal business sources, including databases and reservation systems either manual or computerised • Direct contact with: ▪ Travel suppliers, including airlines, cruise operators, railway operators, bus lines, car rental businesses, limousine hire and taxis ▪ Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services, including travel insurance providers, finance providers, currency exchange, conference and similar venues and interpreters	

2.4 Access <i>selected internal databases</i> and internal business systems 2.5 Access <i>external sources</i> of product information Element 3: Interpret product information 3.1 Identify <i>specific sales needs</i> that form the basis for the search for product information 3.2 Read items that may contain product information 3.3 <i>Integrate sourced product information</i> with identified client needs and/or preferences Element 4: Provide product information 4.1 Interpret <i>industry terminology</i> 4.2 Pass on general information relating to <i>products and services</i> 4.3 Explain <i>specific details</i> about product and services	▪ Tour operators and wholesalers ▪ Travel agencies and associations ▪ Peak travel bodies ▪ Government tourism industry bodies and authorities, including domestic and international bodies • Literature, including reference books, magazines and newspapers • Websites, including individual companies, directories, news sites, surveys and research sites • Personal network of contacts, including those within the host enterprise and those external to the business <i>Product information</i> may relate to: • Travel, including air, cruise, train, bus, car • Destinations, including statistical information and details relating to climate, currency, maps, travel guides, events, languages, history, safety, government information, time zones, culture and communications • Tourist activities and attractions, including natural and man-made • Tours, trips, sight-seeing and excursions • Accommodation facilities, including 5-star to back-packer venues • Services, including medical, personal, entertainment, sporting, shopping • Travel requirements, including requirements relating to entry, passport, visas, warnings and advisory bulletins, customs information • Finance • Travel insurance.
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	<i>Determine usefulness</i> may include: • Defining enterprise needs • Assessing validity, reliability, accuracy, currency and sufficiency of information provided • Evaluating method and speed of access to information provided • Identifying ease of access to information provided • Appraising cost of obtaining information • Complying with enterprise policies and commercial agreements, including agency, sub-agency and franchise requirements • Reviewing the utility of sources on a regular basis. <i>Items that may contain product information</i> will include: • Brochures • Timetables • Tariff sheets, including confidential tariff schedules • Sales and promotion kits • Supplier information kits • Product manuals • Advertising fliers • Manufacturer's specifications • Websites, including downloads from same. <i>Register</i> may include: • Registering on-line • Paying a fee
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	• Establishing required password and username, if required • Lodging host enterprise details with product information source • Establishing the <i>bona fides</i> of the host enterprise • Joining an association or body in order to enable access. <i>Access selected internal databases may include:</i> • Obtaining internal authority to access required fields of information • Setting-up password access authority • Determining folders, documents and locations to use. <i>Access external sources may include:</i> • Telephoning organisations, bodies and authorities • Going on-line • Requesting a visit from sales staff from other organisations. <i>Specific sales needs may relate to:</i> • Non-negotiable client needs, including budget, timing, duration of travel, required destination and activities, health • Requests from and preferences of client, including general enquiries and special interest requests, travel preferences, timing and designated destination activities • Need to provide quotations • Processing a reservation, including booking and coordinating supplier services and products • Issuing non-air documentation • Processing financial transactions, including payment of deposits and full-payment for bookings
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- Need to amend an existing booking due to unforeseen circumstances
 - Cancellations and/or alterations made to bookings.
- Integrate sourced product information may include:*
- Matching availability and data to identified client needs and preferences to the best extent possible
 - Searching for possible alternatives and options
 - Converting supplier codes and abbreviations into usable data to adequately interpret the information provided.
- Industry terminology may include:*
- Industry jargon
 - Industry specifications
 - Common abbreviations
 - Industry and supplier/provider codes
 - Use of 24-hour international time clock
 - Technical capacity of equipment.
- Products and services may include:*
- Transportation and transfers
 - Accommodation, meals, functions and entertainment
 - Tours, cruises and entry to attractions
 - Tour guide services and activities
 - Special events, including special event consumable items
 - Venue and convention facilities, including equipment to support same
 - Speaker, audio-visual, catering, health and financial services.

	<i>Specific details</i> may include: • Costs, tariffs and rates • Conditions and rules • Scheduling information • Product codes • Booking procedures • Points of departure and arrival • Touring inclusions and exclusions • Technical specifications for audio-visual and other meetings and events equipment. Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Understanding and following the enterprise's policies and procedures in regard to accessing product information both internally and externally • Knowledge of major categories of tourism products and services • Using industry terminology, jargon and abbreviations • Ability to convert to and from international time • General knowledge of destinations and travel options • Understanding of the advantages and disadvantages of travel choices, destinations, activities and other travel-related purchasing options. Linkages To Other Units • Access and retrieve computer-based data • Develop and update local knowledge • Maintain quality customer/guest service
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- Use common business tools and technology
- Develop and update tourism industry knowledge
- Promote products and services to customers
- Operate a computerised reservation system
- Maintain product information inventory
- Source and provide destination information and advice
- Construct and apply tourism product research
- Promote tourism products and services.

Critical Aspects of Assessment

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Understanding of arrangements that exist to determine sources of information that are to be used
- Demonstrated ability to evaluate and rate nominated sources of information against given criteria
- Demonstrated ability to access a nominated range of information sources both electronically and paper-based to identify a designated set of information
- Demonstrated ability to communicate product information to clients to meet identified needs and preferences

Context of Assessment

Assessment must ensure:

- Actual or simulated workplace application of techniques to access and interpret product information.

	Resource Implications Training and assessment must include the use of real equipment, with access to the Internet, databases, facilities and products. Assessment Methods The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: • Observation of practical candidate performance • Case studies • Role plays • Oral and written questions • Third party reports completed by a supervisor • Project and assignment work.
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	Key Competencies in this Unit <i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i> <i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i> <i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>		
	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	2	Determine and evaluate suitable sources of product information
	Communicating ideas and information	1	Explain product information to clients
	Planning and organising activities	1	Schedule review of product information sources
	Working with others and in teams	1	Liaise with industry partners and other staff to access and identify relevant information as required by the client
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Calculate costs to ensure compliance with client budget
	Solving problems	1	Develop alternatives for clients to enable their requirements to be met as best as possible
	Using technology	1	Research and access information via the Internet

Notes and PowerPoint slides

Slide

ACCESS AND INTERPRET PRODUCT INFORMATION

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Slide 1

Slide No	Trainer Notes
1.	Trainer welcomes students to class.

Slide

Subject elements

This unit comprises four Elements:

- Identify and evaluate sources of product information
- Access product information
- Interpret product information
- Provide product information



Slide 2

Slide No	Trainer Notes
2.	Trainer advises this Unit comprises four Elements, as listed on the slide explaining: • Each Element comprises a number of Performance Criteria which will be identified throughout the class and explained in detail • Trainees can obtain more detail from their Trainee Manual • At times the course presents advice and information about various protocols but where their workplace requirements differ to what is presented, the workplace practices and standards, as well as policies and procedures must be observed.

Slide

Assessment

Assessment for this unit may include:

- Oral questions
- Written questions
- Work projects
- Workplace observation of practical skills
- Practical exercises
- Formal report from supervisor



Slide 3

Slide No	Trainer Notes
3.	Trainer advises that assessment for this Unit may take several forms all of which are aimed at verifying they have achieved competency for the Unit as required. Trainer indicates the methods of assessment that will be applied to them for this Unit.

Slide

Element 1:

Identify and evaluate sources of product information



Slide 4

Slide No	Trainer Notes
4.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: • What are examples of sources of information? • What is product knowledge? • Why is product knowledge important?

Slide

Identify and evaluate sources of product information

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- List potential sources of product information
- Determine usefulness of product information sources
- Identify items that may contain product information



Slide 5

Slide No	Trainer Notes
5.	Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.

Slide

Role of information

The tourism industry is one of the largest industries in the world and for many countries is its major economy and employer.

Industry knowledge is a vital pre-requisite for effective performance within the industry.



Slide 6

Slide No	Trainer Notes
6.	Class Activity – Questions Get audience to answer following questions: • What information do you need to know to effectively do your job? • What information do you need to know that customers may enquire about? • Where can you get this information?

Slide

Role of information

The idea of obtaining knowledge is so that you can use it for:

- Your benefit
- The benefit of the venue
- The ultimate benefit of the customers



Slide 7

Slide No	Trainer Notes
7.	Class Activity – General Discussion • Identify the benefits for each point.

Slide

Sources of information

Identify potential sources of information

There are endless sources of information that can be collected, analysed and used by a travel and tourism organisation for the benefit of the organisation itself or to assist customers with potential travel plans.

This section will explore:

- Common types of products and services in the tourism industry
- Sources of product and services information
- Identify types of product and services information



Slide 8

Slide No	Trainer Notes
8.	Class Activity – General Discussion • What are examples for each of these points?

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Identify travel and tourism businesses

When compiling product information for your 'product knowledge' data bases, it is essential to identify the different types of businesses in which your potential customers may use.

- What types of businesses do you seek product information from?



Slide 9

Slide No	Trainer Notes
9.	Class Activity – General Discussion Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Summary of travel and tourism businesses

- Air – air travel and associated taxes
- Land – anything that is not air travel or a cruise
- Sea – cruises, ferries etc
- Auxiliary – any product or service that supports the travel experience



Slide 10

Slide No	Trainer Notes
10.	Class Activity – General Discussion • What businesses are contained within each of these sectors?

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Transportation

- Airlines
- Cruise operators
- Railway operators
- Bus lines
- Car rental businesses
- Limousine hire
- Taxis



Slide 11

Slide No	Trainer Notes
11.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Suppliers and providers of support and ancillary services

- Travel insurance providers
- Finance providers
- Currency exchange
- Conference and similar venues
- Interpreters



Slide 12

Slide No	Trainer Notes
12.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business ● Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Accommodation

- Hotels and motels
- Guest houses
- Bed and breakfasts
- Caravan parks and camping grounds
- Resorts
- Time share properties
- Apartments, villas and cottages
- Conference and exhibition centres



Slide 13

Slide No	Trainer Notes
13.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Attractions and Theme Parks

- Museums and galleries
- National parks, wildlife parks and gardens
- Theme parks
- Heritage sites and centres
- Sport and activity centres
- Aquarium and zoos



Slide 14

Slide No	Trainer Notes
14.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business ● Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Tour Operators

- A tour operator typically organises sightseeing tours and accommodation in a particular destination or region
- They act as a middle person between the Wholesaler and the Principal or Supplier of the product



Slide 15

Slide No	Trainer Notes
15.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Inbound Tour Wholesaler

- An Inbound Tour Wholesaler packages products to form a trip for an overseas market travelling to a specific country

Outbound Tour Wholesaler

- An Outbound Tour Wholesaler negotiates product from International Suppliers for clients in a specific travelling to an international destination



Slide 16

Slide No	Trainer Notes
16.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Retail Travel Agents

- A Retail Travel agent is the go-between between the client and the Wholesaler
- It is the Retail agent who obtains all the relevant details from a client to enable them to make a booking through a Wholesaler



Slide 17

Slide No	Trainer Notes
17.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Local, regional and national information services

- These information services exist to assist the public and Travel agents in obtaining information on a particular region from the experts
- This can be at a local, regional or national level



Slide 18

Slide No	Trainer Notes
18.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

MICE

- Meetings
- Incentives
- Conventions
- Exhibitions



Slide 19

Slide No	Trainer Notes
19.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Ministries of Tourism

- Each country within the ASEAN region will have dedicated government ministry specifically focused on the tourism industry
- Their role is to regulate and manage the industry



Slide 20

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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20.	
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Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business

- Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Tourism Boards

- ◉ Coordinate the efforts of hotels, airlines and travel agents to develop the tourism industry of the country
- ◉ Initiate new marketing ideas to promote image abroad
- ◉ Provide travel agent licensing and tourist guide training
- ◉ Promote the development of infrastructure and tourist attractions
- ◉ Organise events to attract visitors



Slide 21

Slide No	Trainer Notes
21.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Industry Authorities

- Authorities are established, either by a government or working closely with government to provide services relating to the tourism industry



Slide 22

Slide No	Trainer Notes
22.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business.

Slide

Travel and tourism businesses

Industry Associations

Industry associations are bodies that all businesses can elect to join that serve specific and over-arching industry sectors.

- Representing the industry
- Offer legal advice
- Provide training
- Identify cost savings



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 1

Slide 23

Slide No	Trainer Notes
23.	Class Activity – Identify businesses for each type of business & Activity • Identify actual companies for each type of tourism business • Complete Activity 1.

Slide

Identify product information

Identify product information to gather

Before seeking information from each of these types of businesses it is important to identify the types of information that you require from each to help you advise your clients in their future travel needs.

- What types of product information do you want to gather?



Slide 24

Slide No	Trainer Notes
24.	Class Activity – Question Discuss the question in the slide.

Slide

Identify product information

Destination information

- General destination information
- Statistical information
- Currency
- Maps
- Travel guides
- Events



Slide 25

Slide No	Trainer Notes
25.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Destination information

- Languages
- Safety
- Government information
- Time zones
- Communications



Slide 26

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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26.

Class Activity – Question

- Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point
- How can you collect this information?
- What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Local community information

- ◉ Local attractions
- ◉ Shopping and retail areas
- ◉ Events and festivals
- ◉ Eateries
- ◉ Supermarkets
- ◉ Local transport
- ◉ Activities
- ◉ Places of worship



Slide 27

Slide No	Trainer Notes
27.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

International destination information

When providing information on international destinations to your customers, you will need to advise them of the government regulations that apply when people wish to leave the country.

- What information do you need to gather and explain to clients wishing to travel overseas?



Slide 28

Slide No	Trainer Notes
28.	Class Activity – Question Discuss the question in the slide.

Slide

Identify product information

Tours

- Company name, name of tour and duration
- Departure date, time and location address
- End date, time and location address
- Type of accommodation e.g. single, twin-share
- Tour company specific baggage labels
- Hotel list
- Tour information booklet
- Included services



Slide 29

Slide No	Trainer Notes
29.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Attractions

Attractions can include:

- Historic sites
- Scenic location
- Special event



Tourist attractions can be:

- Natural
- Man-made

Slide 30

Slide No	Trainer Notes
30.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Activities

- What are examples of tourism related activities?



Slide 31

Slide No	Trainer Notes
31.	Class Activity – Question Discuss the question in the slide.

Slide

Identify product information

History

Many people are interested in history, and therefore information on the history of a destination can be important to customers

- What are examples of history that attracts tourism?



Slide 32

Slide No	Trainer Notes
32.	Class Activity – Question Discuss the question in the slide.

Slide

Identify product information

Geographical features

- Mountain ranges
- Lakes
- Rivers
- Caves
- Waterfalls
- Rock formations
- Beaches
- National parks



Slide 33

Slide No	Trainer Notes
33.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Local customs and culture

Every destination will have customs that are specific to that place and that particular culture.

What are examples of:

- Local customs
- Local culture



Slide 34

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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34.

Class Activity – Question

- Discuss the questions in the slide.

Slide

Identify product information

Climate

It is important that you understand the weather conditions and patterns of the destination.

- Why is this important?
- How can you identify climatic conditions?



Slide 35

Slide No	Trainer Notes
35.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the questions in the slide.

Slide

Identify product information

Accommodation

- Room types
- Tariffs
- Products and services
- Room facilities
- Location and distance to attractions
- Packages
- Blocked dates
- Seasons and times
- Minimum purchase



Slide 36

Slide No	Trainer Notes
36.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Accommodation

- Booking and stay requirements
- Property name and address
- Room type and category
- Number of nights
- Check-in and check-out dates
- Check-in and check-out times



Slide 37

Slide No	Trainer Notes
37.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Accommodation

- Day use or late check-out if applicable
- Inclusions
- Extra charges payable direct
- Special requests
- Special promotions



Slide 38

Slide No	Trainer Notes
38.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Amenities and services

Amenities and services refer to the provision of basic services for travellers including:

- Toilet blocks
- Water
- Electricity
- Food and beverage including restaurants, cafes, bistros
- Medical services



Slide 39

Slide No	Trainer Notes
39.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Amenities and services

- Banks and post offices
- General safety facilities including fire, police emergency services
- Entertainment
- Sporting
- Shopping



Slide 40

Slide No	Trainer Notes
40.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Airlines

- Airline or combination of airlines
- Airport codes
- Airline codes
- City codes
- Flight numbers
- Schedules / timetables
- Destinations
- Routing



Slide 41

Slide No	Trainer Notes
41.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Airlines

- Origin and destination
- Code share flights
- Normal fares
- Discounted fares, including infants, children, students, pensioners and groups
- Fares for unaccompanied children
- Promotional fares and packages
- Taxes



Slide 42

Slide No	Trainer Notes
42.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Airlines

- General air travel rules and restrictions
- Class of travel
- Stopovers
- Mileage restrictions allowed
- Minimum and maximum stays
- Ticketing time limit
- Payment conditions



Slide 43

Slide No	Trainer Notes
43.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Car hire

- Company, category, type
- Pick-up and drop-off depots
- Pick-up and drop-off dates and times
- Inclusions and exclusions
- Special requests
- Notes



Slide 44

Slide No	Trainer Notes
44.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Cruises

- ⦿ Name of the ship and voyage number
- ⦿ Embarkation date, time and port address
- ⦿ Disembarkation date, time and port address
- ⦿ Grade/category and cabin type and number
- ⦿ Passenger dining preference
- ⦿ Pre-booked special requirements



Slide 45

Slide No	Trainer Notes
45.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Transfers

- Name of company providing the transfer
- Local address and local telephone contact
- Type of transfer
- Pick-up date, time and location
- Drop-off date, location
- Special instructions in relation to transfer



Slide 46

Slide No	Trainer Notes
46.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Identify product information

Rail

- Name of Pass
- Duration and type of pass
- Validity dates



Slide 47

Slide No	Trainer Notes
47.	Class Activity – Question • Discuss the types of information to be collected under each point • How can you collect this information? • What format would you like it in?

Slide

Importance of accessing useful product information

Determine usefulness of product information

Whilst there is endless pieces of tourism related information available, it is essential that you are focused on collecting information that will be useful in relation to providing relevant and tailored advice and services to your customers.

- How can you determine with sources are useful?
- How can you determine the information from each source is useful?



Slide 48

Slide No	Trainer Notes
48.	Class Activity – General Discussion Discuss questions in the slide.

Slide

Importance of accessing useful product information

Importance of having useful and appropriate product knowledge

- To demonstrate the professionalism
- To answer routine questions
- Provide destination information and advice
- Provide specific product advice
- To provide additional information
- To advise customers of up-coming events
- To make recommendations and suggestions



Slide 49

Slide No	Trainer Notes
49.	Class Activity – Discuss importance • Discuss importance for each of these points.

Slide

Importance of accessing useful product information

Importance of having useful and appropriate product knowledge

- Selling tourism products
- Quote specific individual tourism product prices
- Booking and coordinating services
- Receiving and processing reservations
- Processing financial transactions
- Issuing customer travel documentation



Slide 50

Slide No	Trainer Notes
50.	Class Activity – Discuss importance • Discuss importance for each of these points.

Slide

Importance of accessing useful product information

Importance of having useful and appropriate product knowledge

- Issuing itineraries
- Explain the features of the products
- To generate repeat business from customers
- To generate referral business
- To comply with general operational requirements



Slide 51

Slide No	Trainer Notes
51.	Class Activity – Discuss importance • Discuss importance for each of these points.

Slide

Importance of accessing useful product information

Methods of determine usefulness of product information

- Defining enterprise needs
- Assessing validity, reliability, accuracy, currency and sufficiency of information provided
- Evaluating method and speed of access to information provided
- Identifying ease of access to information provided



Slide 52

Slide No	Trainer Notes
52.	Class Activity – Discuss importance • Discuss importance for each of these points.

Slide

Importance of accessing useful product information

Methods of determine usefulness of product information

- Appraising cost of obtaining information
- Complying with enterprise policies and commercial agreements, including agency, sub-agency and franchise requirements
- Reviewing the utility of sources on a regular basis



Slide 53

Slide No	Trainer Notes
53.	Class Activity – Discuss importance • Discuss importance for each of these points.

Slide

Importance of accessing useful product information

Assessing information needs

When assessing information needs, do not get overwhelmed with too much information.

Only seek out the information that you need.

- How can you identify what information you need for an organisation?



Slide 54

Slide No	Trainer Notes
54.	Class Activity – General Discussion • Discuss question in the slide • Refer to TM for questions that you can ask to determine informational needs.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Determine the type of items that contain relevant information

The need for information will often determine the type of information required to suit the desired audience.

- What are the different types of items that contain valuable product information?



Slide 55

Slide No	Trainer Notes
55.	Class Activity – Discussion Discuss the question in the slide.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Text-based information

- Brochures, flyers and pamphlets
- Product manuals
- Supplier information and sales kits
- Confidential and general industry tariffs
- Preferred contracts or agreements
- Clue cards
- Fare sheets
- Industry publications, advices and notices



Slide 56

Slide No	Trainer Notes
56.	Class Activity – Discussion & Review information • What information is contained within these informational formats? • Trainer to show examples of each.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Text-based information

- Media articles
- Travel literature
- Travel guides
- Newspapers and magazines
- Timetables
- Reports
- Summaries
- Marketing materials and books



Slide 57

Slide No	Trainer Notes
57.	Class Activity – Discussion & Review information • What information is contained within these informational formats? • Trainer to show examples of each.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Image-based material

Whilst images are often included in text based information, specific image based material can include:

- Photographs
- Recordings
- Videos
- Posters
- Atlases and maps



Slide 58

Slide No

Trainer Notes

58.

Class Activity – Discussion & Review information

- What information is contained within these informational formats?
- Trainer to show examples of each.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Statistics

Statistics is the study of the collection, analysis, interpretation, presentation, and organisation of data.

Statistics can include information relating to:

- Industry as a whole
- Specific to your business



Slide 59

Slide No	Trainer Notes
59.	Class Activity – Identify importance of tourism statistics • Why is it important to gather statistics? • How can it benefit customers? • What information do you seek under each category? • How can you gather this information?

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Industry statistics

- Types of tourism businesses
- Types and demographics of customers
- Top destinations
- Hotel occupancy percentages
- Reasons for stays
- Current industry information
- Destination countries



Slide 60

Slide No	Trainer Notes
60.	Class Activity – Identify importance of tourism industry statistics • Why is it important to gather industry statistics? • How can it benefit customers? • What information do you seek under each category? • How can you gather this information?

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Industry statistics

- Departure months
- Length of stay
- Type of organisation for the trip
- Transport mode
- Accommodation type
- Expenditure
- Popular tourist attractions



Slide 61

Slide No	Trainer Notes
61.	Class Activity – Identify importance of tourism industry statistics • Why is it important to gather industry statistics? • How can it benefit customers? • What information do you seek under each category? • How can you gather this information?

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Testimonials

A testimonial can be a formal statement testifying to:

- Someone's character, performance, professionalism, qualifications, skills or achievements
- The virtues of a company and the products and services it provides
- How the experience benefited them on a personal basis



Slide 62

Slide No	Trainer Notes
62.	Class Activity – Identify importance of testimonials • Why is it important to gather testimonials? • How can they be beneficial?

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Specifications

- A specification refers to the manner in which a good or service is to be provided
- This includes constituents, construction, appearance, performance of a material or apparatus or the standard of workmanship required in its manufacturer



Slide 63

Slide No	Trainer Notes
63.	Class Activity – Discussion & provide example of a specification • Discuss the importance of these methods • Provide example of a specification.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Work or equipment specifications

Work or equipment specifications may relate to:

- Description of equipment or work to be provided
- Standard of equipment or work to be provided
- Purpose of equipment or work to be provided
- Design or capability requirements



Slide 64

Slide No	Trainer Notes
64.	Class Activity – Discussion & provide example of a specification • Provide examples of each.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Quotations

Quotations are used by tourism and travel organisations to sell their products and services, through the use of suppliers, summarised in a way that adds value for the customer.

- What information is normally included in a quotation?



Slide 65

Slide No	Trainer Notes
65.	Class Activity – Discussion & provide example of a quotation Provide examples of each.

Slide

Identify items containing product information

Personal observations

Naturally one of the best types of information that can be used by an organisation is that which has been personally collected.

- Personal notes
- Report and findings
- Log books
- Records of interviews
- Notes of first-hand meetings



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 2

Slide 66

Slide No	Trainer Notes
66.	Class Activity – Discussion & Activity • From a personal perspective, explain how personal observations have provided you with critical information • Complete Activity 2.

Slide

Element 2:

Access product information



Slide 67

Slide No	Trainer Notes
67.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: • What considerations would you have before accessing product information? • What are the steps associated with accessing product information?

Slide

Access product information

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- Select appropriate sources of product information
- Register to receive and/or access product information
- Visit suppliers and other sources to talk with sales staff and obtain items that may contain product information
- Access selected internal databases and internal business systems
- Access external sources of product information



Slide 68

Slide No	Trainer Notes
68.	Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.

Slide

Identify sales needs

Identify specific sales needs

Ultimately the goal of collecting and accessing information is to provide the best possible service and to meet the client's needs thus enabling you to make the sale and process the booking.

The first step in collecting information is to identify the needs or reasons why collecting information is essential.

- What are examples of sales needs?



Slide 69

Slide No	Trainer Notes
69.	Class Activity – Discuss Discuss the question in the slide.

Slide

Identify sales needs

Identify specific sales needs

- Consultation with client
- Non-negotiable client needs, including budget, timing, duration of travel, required destination and activities, health
- Requests from and preferences of client
- Source and provide information and advice
- Make recommendations



Slide 70

Slide No	Trainer Notes
70.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss the importance of each of these sales needs.

Slide

Identify sales needs

Identify specific sales needs

- Check availability and prices
- Provide quotation including booking terms and conditions
- Processing a reservation, including booking and coordinating supplier services and products
- Collect applicable deposits and provide to applicable parties
- Provide written confirmation and due dates for final payment
- Collect final payment and provide to applicable parties



Slide 71

Slide No	Trainer Notes
71.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss the importance of each of these sales needs.

Slide

Identify sales needs

Identify specific sales needs

- Processing financial transactions, including payment of deposits and full-payment for bookings
- Issue or secure non-air and air travel documentation and provide to customer
- Need to amend an existing booking due to unforeseen circumstances
- Cancellations or alterations made to bookings



Slide 72

Slide No	Trainer Notes
72.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss the importance of each of these sales needs.

Slide

Define search topic and objectives

Defining the topics and objectives

The first step is to try to identify exactly where the focus of research and information collection should be concentrated on

- Determining specific research topics
- Define research objectives



Slide 73

Slide No	Trainer Notes
73.	Class Activity – Discuss For a case study of your choice, identify: • A research topic • Research objectives.

Slide

Access product information

Methods used to search identified sources

- Subscribing to publications
- Reading newspapers
- Getting on Internet e-mail lists
- Joining your local union or industry association
- Reading articles on the industry sector
- Getting out and having a look around
- Interrogating databases
- Asking
- Conducting web based searches
- Exploring options



Slide 74

Slide No	Trainer Notes
74.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Discuss these methods based on personal experience • What other methods can be used?

Slide

Identify information timelines

Identify the timelines for accessing information

Not only is it important to identify the types of information needed, but also when it needs to be collected and available for use.

- What are considerations when identifying timelines for information?
- What are examples of timelines for accessing information?



Slide 75

Slide No	Trainer Notes
75.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Discuss the questions in the slide.

Slide

Identify information budgets

Identify budget for accessing and interpreting information

- Time allocation to undertake research
- Staff to undertake research or assist in the analysis, preparation and presentation of the material captured
- Funds to obtain secondary research data
- Funds to enable the undertaking of primary market research
- Materials, registrations, subscriptions and other activities necessary to register to receive or to purchase identified information



Slide 76

Slide No	Trainer Notes
76.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Identify some costs based on a particular case study of your choice.

Slide

Identify information found

Identify information found

Once you have searched and found relevant information, it is important to 'identify' relevant information so that it can be used again for the purpose or filing, further review or use in operational activities.

It is important to 'mark' the information so that it can be easily found for future use.

- How can you 'identify or mark' information found for later use?



Slide 77

Slide No	Trainer Notes
77.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: Discuss the question in the slide.

Slide

Identify information found

Identify information found

Methods to identify relevant information includes:

- Book marking websites
- Recording sources in a project-specific index
- Copy and pasting key points into separate files
- Highlighting key information
- Filing documents in a logical order



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 3

Slide 78

Slide No	Trainer Notes
78.	Class Activity – Discussion & Activity Ask general questions: • What are the benefits of these methods? • What other methods can be used? • Complete Activity 3.

Slide

Access external information

Once you have identified types of information you wish to gather from different sources, it is now time to contact them and request information to be sent to your organisation.

- How can you receive information?
- What are the activities associated with receiving information from sources?
- What are examples of external sources of information?



Slide 79

Slide No	Trainer Notes
79.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Discuss the questions in the slide.

Slide

Access external information

Objectives when contacting external sources

- Making contact with tourism businesses
- Introducing your business to the organisation
- Identify if the tourism business 'fits' your company profile or image
- Gain an understanding of the tourism products and services they provide
- Understand their 'promotional message' and how to promote their products and services
- Discuss contractual agreements and terms and conditions for working together
- Requesting product information



Slide 80

Slide No	Trainer Notes
80.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Discuss these objectives • How can you meet these objectives? • What other objectives may you have?

Slide

Access external information

Making contact with tourism businesses

- Telephoning targeted businesses
- Making face-to-face requests of sales staff that visit the office
- Making e-mail requests
- Registering to receive information, newsletters and updates



Slide 81

Slide No	Trainer Notes
81.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Discuss activities associated with these points.

Slide

Access external information

Introducing your business to the organisation

- Name of company
- Location
- Licence Number
- Key contacts
- Products and services provided
- Identification of clients
- Competitive advantages of your organisation
- What you are seeking in a partnership



Slide 82

Slide No	Trainer Notes
82.	Class Activity – Discussion • Why is it important to introduce your organisation?

Slide

Access external information

Identify if the tourism business 'fits' your company profile or image

- For any successful partnership to take place, both companies must work with companies that match or reflect their own image and vision
- When companies work together, the practices of one of the businesses will impact on the brand of the other
- The key is to provide mutual benefit



Slide 83

Slide No	Trainer Notes
83.	Class Activity – Discussion • Why is it important to have a 'fit'?

Slide

Access external information

Gain an understanding of the tourism products and services they provide

One of the most important aspects of contacting a tour company is to gain an understanding of what they can offer to your client.

- Identify key features and benefits
- Ask questions
- Arrange familiarisations



Slide 84

Slide No	Trainer Notes
84.	Class Activity – Discussion What else can you do to gain a 'better understanding' of a tourism business?

Slide

Access external information

Understand their 'promotional message' and how to promote their products and services

- Identify their promotional activities
- Identify their special offers



Slide 85

Slide No	Trainer Notes
85.	Class Activity – Discussion • How can you gather information relating to 'current' promotional activities and special offers?

Slide

Access external information

Discuss contractual agreements and terms and conditions for working together

- Commercial agreements
- Contract of sale
- Contract rates
- Incentives
- Bookings, confirmation and conditions



Slide 86

Slide No	Trainer Notes
86.	Class Activity – Discussion • What other contractual agreement points may need to be negotiated?

Slide

Access external information

Requesting product information

- Once all necessary arrangements have been made it is now time to request product information
- Try to make the formats selected the most 'user friendly' and cost effective
- Brochures are one of the most commonly requested formats of product information



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 4

Slide 87

Slide No	Trainer Notes
87.	Class Activity – Discussion & Activity • What is the best way to get product information from overseas tourism organisations? • Complete Activity 4.

Slide

Access external information

Registering for information

- Quite often you may need to gather more generic information relating to the industry as a whole, including any new laws, regulations, businesses or trends
- In order to access this information you will need to register to receive it



Slide 88

Slide No	Trainer Notes
88.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • What are examples of publications you need to register for? • How can you register to access information?

Slide

Access external information

Registering for information

- Registering for industry information may include:
- Registering online
- Paying a fee
- Establishing required password and username, if required



Slide 89

Slide No	Trainer Notes
89.	Class Activity – Discussion • Discuss these points • Provide an example of each.

Slide

Access external information

Registering for information

- Lodging host enterprise details with product information source
- Establishing the bona fides of the host enterprise
- Joining an association or body in order to enable access

COMPLETE ACTIVITY 5



Slide 90

Slide No	Trainer Notes
90.	Class Activity – Discussion & Activity • Discuss these points • Provide an example of each • Complete Activity 5.

Slide

Access external information

Seeking external assistance

- To gather further information
- For acquisition of specialised information
- To interpret existing information gathered
- Provide findings and recommendations
- To clarify information
- To answer any questions



Slide 91

Slide No	Trainer Notes
91.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • What are reasons exist?

Slide

Access external information

Establishing industry networks

- Developing your own industry network
- Networking with industry colleagues



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 6

Slide 92

Slide No	Trainer Notes
92.	Class Activity – Discussion & Activity ● Complete Activity 6.

Slide

Visit identified sources

- At times you may be required to visit identified sources
- This opportunity to gather a first-hand understanding of the source, including key personnel who will be instrumental in sharing information is very beneficial



Slide 93

Slide No	Trainer Notes
93.	Class Activity – Discuss What are the benefits of visiting identified sources?

Slide

Visit identified sources

Benefits of visiting identified sources

- Meet key personnel
- Talking with personnel to obtain, clarify, update and identify supplementary relevant information
- Gain an understanding of the operation
- Viewing operations and making personal observations
- Clarify and explain your request for information
- Receive electronic and hard copy files in a user friendly manner



Slide 94

Slide No	Trainer Notes
94.	Class Activity – Discuss ● Discuss these benefits of visiting identified sources.

Slide

Visit identified sources

Benefits of visiting identified sources

- Reviewing additional information available at the source
- Get any questions answered
- Identify the potential of informational sources that can be utilised at a later date
- Recording interviews and taking photographs or other recorded images



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 7

Slide 95

Slide No	Trainer Notes
95.	Class Activity – Discuss & Activity • Discuss these benefits of visiting identified sources • Complete Activity 7.

Slide

Access internal information

Extract information from internal information sources

Besides meeting with external sources, the greatest source of information that relates to a tourism organisation, is from the organisation itself.

- What are examples of internal information sources?



Slide 96

Slide No	Trainer Notes
96.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Access internal information

Types of internal information sources

- Customer databases
- Sales figures
- Internal reports
- Accounting and operational statistics
- Data from sub-agencies and head office
- Customer feedback information
- Automated information systems
- Computerised reservation systems
- Products and services inventories



Slide 97

Slide No	Trainer Notes
97.	Class Activity – Discuss • What information can come from each of these sources?

Slide

Access internal information

Arrange to receive internal information

- Who can you receive information from?
- What types of information can you receive?
- How can you receive the information?



Slide 98

Slide No	Trainer Notes
98.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Discuss the questions in the slide.

Slide

Access internal databases

Options for storing product information

Product information inventory systems may be:

- Manual filing systems
- Computerised systems
- Combination of the above



Slide 99

Slide No	Trainer Notes
99.	Class Activity – Discuss • Provide examples of each system.

Slide

Access internal databases

Manual filing systems

- Public area displays
- Back of house storage areas
- Filing cabinets
- Suspension files
- Personal information manual
- Contact details of tourism businesses



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 8

Slide 100

Slide No	Trainer Notes
100.	Class Activity – Discussion & Activity • Discuss how these systems can be managed and maintained • Complete Activity 8.

Slide

Access internal databases

Computerised systems

A Global Distribution System (GDS) is a network operated by a company that enables automated transactions between third parties and booking agents in order to provide travel-related services to the end consumers

- What are examples of GDS systems?



Slide 101

Slide No	Trainer Notes
101.	Class Activity – Discussion • Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Access internal databases

Global Distribution Systems

The major GDS systems include:

- Travelport (Galileo, & Apollo)
- Travelport (Worldspan)
- Amadeus
- Sabre



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 9

Slide 102

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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102.	
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	Class Activity –Activity
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- | | |
|--|--|
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Complete Activity 9. |
|--|--|

Slide

Access internal databases

Policies and procedures

All tourism organisations will have a range of policies and procedures relating to the way in which product information will be managed.

In summary:

- A policy is a rule or statement
- A procedure is a step by step instruction on how a specific incident or activity should be conducted



Slide 103

Slide No	Trainer Notes
103.	Class Activity –Discussion • What are examples of policies and procedures that apply to the management of product information inventory?

Slide

Access internal databases

Gathering information from customers

- Customer comment cards
- Interviews and follow up calls
- General discussion
- Observations



Slide 104

Slide No	Trainer Notes
104.	Class Activity – Discussion Ask general questions: • Provide examples of comment cards • How else can you get feedback from customers?

Slide

Element 3:

Interpret product information



Slide 105

Slide No	Trainer Notes
105.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: • What is the purpose of interpreting product information you have received? • What are the steps associated with interpreting product information?

Slide

Interpret product information

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- Identify specific sales needs that form the basis for the search for product information
- Read items that may contain product information
- Integrate sourced product information with identified client needs and/or preferences



Slide 106

Slide No**Trainer Notes**

106.

Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.

Slide

Read items containing product information

Importance of reading information

- Once information has been accessed, it is important that it is read and understood
- It is essential that not only do you understand the information you have accessed, but that it is accurate and relevant for the customers



Slide 107

Slide No	Trainer Notes
107.	Class Activity –Discussion • Why is this important? • What are the objectives of reading product information collected?

Slide

Read items containing product information

Verify completeness, accuracy and currency of information

It is of vital importance that the information you provide to your customer is:

- Accurate
- Readily understood by the customer
- Provided in a timely manner
- Provided in an appropriate format and style
- Provided in an appropriate depth and scope



Slide 108

Slide No	Trainer Notes
108.	Class Activity –Discussion • How can you achieve each of these points?

Slide

Read items containing product information

Methods to ensure accuracy of information

- Identify date in which current information was compiled
- Checking version of the brochure or information
- Checking on the website for accurate 'real time' information
- Contacting the supplier to verify information



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 10

Slide 109

Slide No	Trainer Notes
109.	Class Activity –Discussion & Activity • What else can you do? • Complete Activity 10.

Slide

Read and review information

Importance of reviewing information

- Once you have captured information that has been collect or given to you by various sources and organisations it is now time to review the information and determine its importance, accuracy and relevancy for your organisation



Slide 110

Slide No

Trainer Notes

110.

Class Activity – Discuss

- How can you do this?

Slide

Read and review information

Objectives of reviewing captured information

- Confirming the applicability and utility of material researched and provided
- Determining degree of usefulness of the information
- Determining if additional information, material or data is required to meet identified needs
- Verifying the accuracy, relevance and sources of the data



Slide 111

Slide No	Trainer Notes
111.	Class Activity – Discuss • Why are these objectives important? • What other objectives would you have?

Slide

Read and review information

Objectives of reviewing captured information

- Ensuring that no obvious sources of information have been overlooked
- Meeting with the information user to check that the material gathered is appropriate for their needs
- Meeting with researchers to clarify points of ambiguity, as appropriate



Slide 112

Slide No	Trainer Notes
112.	Class Activity – Discuss • Why are these objectives important? • What other objectives would you have?

Slide

Interpreting information

Interpreting information

- The aim of interpreting information is to analyse all the information collected with the hope of providing a summary of key pieces of evidence in which assumptions, conclusions and recommendations be based



Slide 113

Slide No	Trainer Notes
113.	Class Activity – Discuss • What activities are associated with interpreting information?

Slide

Interpreting information

Purpose of interpreting information

- Gaining further understanding of the information
- Identifying any questions you may have
- Identify the key points in which you may convey to stakeholders, colleagues or clients



Slide 114

Slide No	Trainer Notes
114.	Class Activity – Discuss • Why is this important?

Slide

Interpreting information

Interpreting information

- Analysis and interpreting the Information
- Classifying the information
- Preparing summaries with supporting evidence of the results of the data analysis



Slide 115

Slide No	Trainer Notes
115.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss the steps associated with each of these points.

Slide

Integrate information to meet client needs

Integrating information

- Once you have reviewed and interpreted the information, it is now time to integrate the information to meet the needs of the organisation and the client



Slide 116

Slide No

Trainer Notes

116.

Class Activity – Discuss

- Why is it important to integrate information?
- How can you integrate information to meet the needs of the organisation?
- How can you integrate information to meet the needs of the client?

Slide

Integrate information to meet client needs

Integrating information

Whilst there may be vast amounts of information that may be of benefit, it is time to identify:

- ◉ Which pieces of information do not need to be communicated or not relevant
- ◉ Which pieces of information are essential
- ◉ Key points that need to be communicated
- ◉ The order of priority for communicating information
- ◉ How to structure the information



Slide 117

Slide No	Trainer Notes
117.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss importance of these points.

Slide

Manipulate captured information

Activities associated with manipulating captured information

Integrate sourced product information may include preparing a quotation that results from:

- Matching availability and data to identified client needs and preferences to the best extent possible
- Searching for possible alternatives and options
- Converting supplier codes and abbreviations into usable data to adequately interpret the information provided



Slide 118

Slide No	Trainer Notes
118.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss importance of these points.

- What information is contained within a quotation?



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Product information

Slide

Information contained in a quotation

General information

- Date of quotation and reference number (if applicable)
- Clients name
- Phone contacts
- Email address
- Address
- Dates of travel
- Length of travel and class of travel



Slide 120

Slide No	Trainer Notes
120.	Class Activity – Discuss & Review a quotation • Discuss importance of these points.

Slide

Information contained in a quotation

Travel products and services

- Flights
- Accommodation
- Cruises
- Tours
- Other travel products and services
- Transfers
- Car hire/Rentals



Slide 121

Slide No	Trainer Notes
121.	Class Activity – Discuss & Review a quotation • Discuss importance of these points • Refer to points on TM Pages 77 & 78.

Slide

Information contained in a quotation

Specific details

- Seasonality
- Availability
- Costing considerations
- Additional travel costs
- Product price increases
- Fluctuations in exchange rates
- Terms and conditions
- Scheduling information



Slide 122

Slide No	Trainer Notes
122.	Class Activity – Discuss & Review a quotation • Discuss importance of these points.

Slide

Information contained in a quotation

Specific details

- Product codes
- Booking procedures
- Points of departure and arrival
- Touring inclusions and exclusions
- Technical specifications for audio-visual and other meetings and events equipment
- Travel insurance



Slide 123

Slide No	Trainer Notes
123.	Class Activity – Discuss & Review a quotation • Discuss importance of these points.

Slide

Information contained in a quotation

Specific details

- Visa / permits
- Health permits
- Limitations
- Safety and risk – adventure products
- Non operation of the product – tour cancellation



Slide 124

Slide No	Trainer Notes
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124.	Class Activity – Discuss & Review a quotation • Discuss importance of these points.
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Slide

Quotation Protocols

Key quotation protocols

- Use official company stationery
- Date the quote
- Avoid the use of jargon
- Ensure correct spelling and grammar
- Include Customer/Passenger names



Slide 125

Slide No	Trainer Notes
125.	Class Activity – Discuss & Review a quotation • Discuss importance of these protocols.

Slide

Quotation Protocols

Key quotation protocols

- Specify currency
- Provide both a per person and total price
- State validity of the quote
- Detail all the arrangements included in the quote
- Follow a logical and sequential order for arrangements



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 11

Slide 126

Slide No	Trainer Notes
126.	Class Activity – Discuss & Review a quotation & Activity • Discuss importance of these protocols • Complete Activity 11.

Slide

Element 4: Provide product information



Slide 127

Slide No	Trainer Notes
127.	Introduce topic. Class Activity – General Discussion Ask general questions: • How can you provide information to clients? • What needs to be considered when providing information? • Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.

Slide

Provide product information

Performance Criteria for this Element are:

- Interpret industry terminology
- Pass on general information relating to products and services
- Explain specific details about product and services



Slide 128

Slide No

Trainer Notes

128.

Trainer identifies the Performance Criteria for this Element, as listed on the slide.

Slide

Interpret industry terminology

Need to interpret industry terminology

One of the key components of receiving product information is to interpret and translate industry terminology in a manner that will be understood by customers.

- Why is this important?
- What should be interpreted?
- How can you interpret information?



Slide 129

Slide No	Trainer Notes
129.	Class Activity – Discussion • Discuss questions in the slide.

Slide

Interpret industry terminology

Methods to interpret industry terminology

- Understanding resources, including interpreting codes, abbreviations, acronyms and individual supplier terminology
- Converting currencies
- Interpreting terms and conditions
- Understanding limitations and elements of products and services, especially packages and deals
- Identifying fees and charges



Slide 130

Slide No

Trainer Notes

130.

Class Activity – Discussion

- What other methods can be used?

Slide

Interpret industry terminology

Interpreting codes, abbreviations and terminology

- Phonetic alphabet
- The 24-hour clock
- Airport city codes
- Airline codes



COMPLETE ACTIVITIES 12 & 13

Slide 131

Slide No	Trainer Notes
131.	Class Activity – Discussion & Review codes, abbreviations and terminology • Review the codes, abbreviations and terminology in the TM • Complete Activities 12 & 13.

Slide

Interpret industry terminology

Interpreting codes, abbreviations and terminology

- Cruise ship terminology
- Tours terminology
- Car hire terminology
- Rail travel terminology
- Accommodation terminology
- Insurance terminology



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 14

Slide 132

Slide No	Trainer Notes
132.	Class Activity – Discussion & Review codes, abbreviations and terminology & Activity • Review the codes, abbreviations and terminology in the TM • Complete Activity 14.

Slide

Identify travel documentation

Travel Documentation

Besides having to interpret industry terminology, it is essential that you also understand the different types of travel documentation that will be used, either by the organisation or given to customers, as part of the travel experience.

Travel documentation will related to:

- Non-air documentation
- Air documentation



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 15

Slide 133

Slide No	Trainer Notes
133.	Class Activity – List types of Non-air & Air documentation & Activity • What are examples of each? • Complete Activity 15.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Presenting information to the customer

Once the final quotation has been confirmed, with staff understanding all necessary terminology and documentation that makes up the travel quotation of booking, it is now time to present the information and relevant documentation to the customer.

- What are submissions considerations when passing on information?



Slide 134

Slide No	Trainer Notes
134.	Class Activity – Discuss Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Submission considerations

- Location of the customer
- Number of persons to receive quotation
- Reliability of submission methods
- Types of documentation required
- Time frames required
- Costs



Slide 135

Slide No	Trainer Notes
135.	Class Activity – Discuss submission considerations • How do they impact submission methods?

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Customer service basics when presenting information

- Have comprehensive product knowledge
- Remember to consider customer needs, wants and preferences
- Ask questions
- Be proactive
- Provide information, recommendations, advice and suggestions that aligns with identified customer need



Slide 136

Slide No	Trainer Notes
136.	Class Activity – Discuss importance of customer service basics • Trainer to discuss importance of these customer service basics points.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Customer service basics when presenting quotations

- Sell the benefits of products and services
- Overcome objections by customers to making a purchase
- Allow customers time and opportunity to consider their purchase
- Make legitimate all add-on/complementary sales
- Close the sale



Slide 137

Slide No	Trainer Notes
137.	Class Activity – Discuss importance of customer service basics • Trainer to discuss importance of these customer service basics points.

Slide

Expand and explain quotation

Providing quotation information

When you provide information to customers it is absolutely essential that it is:

- Up-to-date
- Accurate
- Comprehensive
- Honest
- Straight-forward
- Easily interpreted and understood
- Concise



Slide 138

Slide No	Trainer Notes
138.	Class Activity Role Play – Providing a quotation to a customer (Slides 149-152) • Again, in groups and either based on Work Activities case study or Trainer's scenarios, provide quotation to a customer • Trainer to demonstrate steps, key activities and important points.

Slide

Expand and explain quotation

Key aspects of providing a quotation

- Details about physical products
- Information about the services that are available
- Information on prices, Specials, deals and packages
- Providing personal interpretation and explanation of the quotation
- Providing supplementary information as required



Slide 139

Slide No	Trainer Notes
139.	Class Activity Role Play – Providing a quotation to a customer (Slides 149-152) • Again, in groups and either based on Work Activities case study or Trainer's scenarios, provide quotation to a customer • Trainer to demonstrate steps, key activities and important points.

Slide

Expand and explain quotation

Key aspects of providing a quotation

- Explaining the reasons for charges and fees included in the quotation
- Assisting the client to understand the reputation and expertise of nominated suppliers, providers and carriers
- Providing supporting brochures and marketing materials to assist with understanding of the quotation



Slide 140

Slide No	Trainer Notes
140.	Class Activity Role Play – Providing a quotation to a customer (Slides 149-152) • Again, in groups and either based on Work Activities case study or Trainer's scenarios, provide quotation to a customer • Trainer to demonstrate steps, key activities and important points.

Slide

Expand and explain quotation

Interpersonal skills when providing quotation information

- Engaged with the process of providing information
- Courteous and polite
- Sensitive and understanding
- Committed to the exchange
- Culturally sensitive and appropriate



Slide 141

Slide No	Trainer Notes
141.	Class Activity Role Play – Providing a quotation to a customer (Slides 149-152) • Again, in groups and either based on Work Activities case study or Trainer's scenarios, provide quotation to a customer • Trainer to demonstrate steps, key activities and important points.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Information submission methods

Information are provided to customers in one of the following ways:

- Verbal explanation
- Provide hard copy materials
- Provide electronic materials



Slide 142

Slide No	Trainer Notes
142.	Class Activity – Discuss submission methods What are the advantages and disadvantages of using each method?

Slide

Verbal explanation

Benefits of providing a verbal explanation

- Explain in more detail the key pieces of information in them
- Answer any questions customers may have
- Provide suggestions and recommendations
- Outline the processes associated with confirming and organising travel arrangements
- Guide them through the sales process



Slide 143

Slide No	Trainer Notes
143.	Class Activity – Discuss • Discuss these benefits.

Slide

Providing hard copy materials

Benefits of providing hard copy materials

- Utilises an additional learning method
- Provides comprehensive information
- Provides appealing images
- Provides information in its intended message
- Enables the audience to review information at their own time and at their own pace
- Enables information to be reviewed on multiple purposes
- Enables the audience to show other people information as well
- Enables audience to become familiar with content



Slide 144

Slide No	Trainer Notes
144.	Class Activity – Discuss ● Discuss these benefits.

Slide

Providing hard copy materials

Types of hard copy materials

- Reports
- Brochures
- Quotations
- Invitations
- Travel itineraries
- Handouts
- Fact sheets
- Notes



Slide 145

Slide No	Trainer Notes
145.	Class Activity – Show examples of hard copy materials • Show examples.

Slide

Providing hard copy materials

Types of hard copy materials

- Photocopies from policy manuals
- Texts
- Media articles
- Photographs
- Posters
- Flyers
- Marketing materials
- Financial statements



Slide 146

Slide No	Trainer Notes
146.	Class Activity – Show examples of hard copy materials • Show examples.

Slide

Providing electronic materials

Benefits of distributing electronic materials

- Information can be shared instantaneously
- It guarantees the intended audience receives the information, unlike mail which may go missing
- It enables the sender to see who has received and read the information
- Information can be sent to numerous people
- Information can be sent securely enabling information to remain confidential



Slide 147

Slide No	Trainer Notes
147.	Class Activity – Show examples of hard copy materials • Show examples.

Slide

Providing electronic materials

Benefits of distributing electronic materials

- It can be distributed to people around the world, regardless of location
- It is a cost effective method of distributing information
- It reduces storage space required for hard copy documents
- it can be stored in shared 'cloud' systems for access by many people
- Information stored in electronic systems can be updated easily



Slide 148

Slide No	Trainer Notes
148.	Class Activity – Show examples of hard copy materials • Show examples.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Types of products and services information to communicate

In summary product and services information to explain to customers may include:

- Transportation and transfers
- Accommodation, meals, functions and entertainment
- Tours, cruises and entry to attractions



Slide 149

Slide No	Trainer Notes
149.	Class Activity – Discuss the information to be provided under each point • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Types of products and services information to communicate

- Tour guide services and activities
- Special events, including special event consumable items
- Venue and convention facilities, including equipment to support same
- Speaker, audio-visual, catering, health and financial services



Slide 150

Slide No	Trainer Notes
150.	Class Activity – Discuss the information to be provided under each point • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Flight information

- ◉ Airline details
- ◉ Destinations and routings
- ◉ Class of travel
- ◉ Departure and return dates
- ◉ Fare validity
- ◉ Air fare per person
- ◉ Taxes per person



Slide 151

Slide No	Trainer Notes
151.	Class Activity – Discuss information content • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Accommodation information

- Name of accommodation and location
- Room type and bedding configurations
- Check-in and check-out dates
- Total number of nights
- Any extras or inclusions such as meals, transfers etc
- Cost per person per night and total amount for the stay



Slide 152

Slide No	Trainer Notes
152.	Class Activity – Discuss information content • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Car hire/Rentals information

- Name of company they are using – Avis, Budget, Hertz etc
- Vehicle group or type – compact, midsize, group C etc
- Transmission – manual or automatic
- Pick up and drop off dates, times and location
- Rate – if paying direct
- Rental Inclusions – mileage, additional drivers, insurances, taxes
- Any additional local payments for additional services e.g. GPS



Slide 153

Slide No	Trainer Notes
153.	Class Activity – Discuss information content • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Cruises information

- Name of the cruise line or company
- Name of the ship
- Name of cruise, including code
- Number of days or nights
- Departure date, time and location
- Return date, arrival time and location
- Cabin type and deck location



Slide 154

Slide No	Trainer Notes
154.	Class Activity – Discuss information content • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Tours

- Tour company name
- Tour name, code and duration
- Departure date, time and location/city
- Arrival date, time and location/city
- Rooming details – single, twin, triple
- Inclusions



Slide 155

Slide No	Trainer Notes
155.	Class Activity – Discuss information content • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Transfers

- Date, time and location of transfers
- Type of transfer – seat in coach, private transfers, limousine etc



Slide 156

Slide No	Trainer Notes
156.	Class Activity – Discuss information content • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Pass on information to clients

Insurance

- Company used
- Policy type and length of policy
- Type of cover
- Reference to PDS (Product Disclosure Statement)



Slide 157

Slide No	Trainer Notes
157.	Class Activity – Discuss information content • Discuss possible content under each point.

Slide

Explain specific details

Explain specific details about product and services

In the previous section, general information relating to products and services required by customers have been identified.

Whilst the information provided will be related to the type of travel experience sought by customers, there is other specific information that needs to be communicated with customers.

- What are examples of other specific information to be communicated?



Slide 158

Slide No	Trainer Notes
158.	Class Activity – Discussion Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Explain specific details

Types of specific details

Regardless of the tourism products and services requested by customers the range of specific details that must also be explained to the customer include:

- Seasonality
- Availability
- Costing considerations
- Additional travel costs
- Product price increases
- Fluctuations in exchange rates



Slide 159

Slide No	Trainer Notes
159.	Class Activity – Discussion • Discuss the content for each specific detail.

Slide

Explain specific details

Types of specific details

- Booking conditions
- Terms and conditions
- Scheduling information
- Product codes
- Booking procedures
- Points of departure and arrival
- Touring inclusions and exclusions



Slide 160

Slide No	Trainer Notes
160.	Class Activity – Discussion ● Discuss the content for each specific detail.

Slide

Explain specific details

Types of specific details

- Technical specifications for audio-visual and other meetings and events equipment
- Travel insurance
- Limitations
- Safety and risk – adventure products
- Non operation of the product – tour cancellation



Slide 161

Slide No	Trainer Notes
161.	Class Activity – Discussion • Discuss the content for each specific detail.

Slide

Explain specific details

Seasonality

- High season – most expensive
- Shoulder season – in between
- Low season – least expensive



Slide 162

Slide No	Trainer Notes
162.	Class Activity – Discussion • What organisations are influenced by seasonality? • Provide examples how tourism organisations change their offering due to seasonality.

Slide

Explain specific details

Availability & confirmation details required

- ⦿ What has been booked and confirmed
- ⦿ Who it has been booked for (the full name)
- ⦿ The terms and conditions
- ⦿ Deposit and payment amounts (dates due)
- ⦿ Acceptable forms of payment
- ⦿ Credit card merchant fees



Slide 163

Slide No	Trainer Notes
163.	Class Activity – Discussion • What are common methods and conditions to confirm travel arrangements?

Slide

Explain specific details

Costing considerations

- Seasonality
- Validity dates
- Date of booking
- Date of travel
- Surcharges
- Restrictions
- Standard
- Inclusions/exclusions



Slide 164

Slide No	Trainer Notes
164.	Class Activity – Discussion ● Discuss the impact on these costing considerations.

Slide

Explain specific details

Costing considerations

- Bedding
- Child and infant costs
- Currency used and conversion rates
- Payments
- Conditions of sale
- Packages versus single items sold
- Stay Pay
- Last minute deals and spot specials



Slide 165

Slide No	Trainer Notes
165.	Class Activity – Discussion • Discuss the impact on these costing considerations.

Slide

Explain specific details

Additional travel costs

- Mandatory organisation service, transaction or planning fee etc
- Insurance
- Visa
- Airport taxes
- Merchant fees
- Any taxes and levies which are payable direct and which are not included in the quotation
- Extra charges
- Exchange rate fluctuation



Slide 166

Slide No	Trainer Notes
166.	Class Activity – Discussion ● Provide examples of these additional travel costs.

Slide

Explain specific details

Product price increases

- ⦿ Expiration of the airfare
- ⦿ Interpretation of airfare rules by the consultant
- ⦿ Missed ticket deadline
- ⦿ Change in taxes and levies
- ⦿ Fuel surcharges



Slide 167

Slide No	Trainer Notes
167.	Class Activity – Discussion • Provide examples of these product price increases.

Slide

Explain specific details

Booking conditions

- How to book – who to contact
- Amount of deposit required
- Prices and validity
- Assumption of risk
- Exclusion of liability
- Payment deadline
- Ticketing deadline



Slide 168

Slide No	Trainer Notes
168.	Class Activity – Discuss booking conditions • What information would you need to discuss for each of these points?

Slide

Explain specific details

Booking conditions

- Extension ticketing deadline
- Cancellation by the supplier
- Force Majeure
- Cancellation by the travel agent
- Cancellation charges
- Availability of any type of change to booking



Slide 169

Slide No	Trainer Notes
169.	Class Activity – Discuss booking conditions • What information would you need to discuss for each of these points?

Slide

Explain specific details

Booking conditions

- Availability of changes to class of booking
- Types of booking amendments
- Amendment fees
- Complaints
- Authority of suppliers and tour leaders
- Baggage allowance



Slide 170

Slide No

Trainer Notes

170.

Class Activity – Discuss booking conditions

- What information would you need to discuss for each of these points?

Slide

Explain specific details

Booking conditions

- Excess baggage charges
- Health, fitness and age limits
- Publicity
- Privacy
- Governing law



Slide 171

Slide No	Trainer Notes
171.	Class Activity – Discuss booking conditions • What information would you need to discuss for each of these points?

Slide

Explain specific details

Identify terms and conditions

All quotations will come with terms and conditions that will apply to various aspects of travel arrangements.

Terms and conditions may be provided by:

- The travel agent themselves
- Suppliers
- The individual product or service provider



Slide 172

Slide No	Trainer Notes
172.	Class Activity – List terms and conditions Audience to prepare list of all possible terms and conditions affecting travel bookings and arrangements.

Slide

Explain specific details

Types of terms and conditions

- Terms and methods of payment
- Dates for payment of deposits and final payment
- Notifications regarding final confirmation of the booking
- Cancellations and penalties and charges that apply
- Procedures and charges that apply to name and date changes for the booking
- Guarantees and warranties that apply to the products and services covered by the quotation



Slide 173

Slide No	Trainer Notes
173.	Class Activity – Discuss terms and conditions • What is the purpose of each of these terms and conditions? • What are examples / stipulations of each of these terms and conditions?

Slide

Explain specific details

Types of terms and conditions

- Exclusion and limitation of liability clauses
- Identification of the period for which the quotation is valid
- Whether or not the quotation is subject to change with or without notice
- Reference to associated terms and conditions as imposed by third party providers
- General industry rules, regulations and codes



Slide 174

Slide No	Trainer Notes
174.	Class Activity – Discuss terms and conditions • What is the purpose of each of these terms and conditions? • What are examples / stipulations of each of these terms and conditions?

Slide

Explain specific details

Travel Agent Terms and Conditions

They will commonly include terms and conditions relating to:

- Deposit and how to book
- Payment Options
- Amendments
- Final Payment
- Cancellations and refunds



Slide 175

Slide No	Trainer Notes
175.	Class Activity – Discuss terms and conditions • What is the purpose of each of these terms and conditions? • What are examples / stipulations of each of these terms and conditions?

Slide

Explain specific details

Supplier Terms and Conditions

It is important that all supplier, wholesaler, operator conditions are highlighted to the customer together with your own travel agent terms and conditions.

- What are examples of supplier terms and conditions?



Slide 176

Slide No	Trainer Notes
176.	Class Activity – Discuss questions Discuss questions in the slide.

Slide

Explain specific details

Product or service provider terms and conditions

Individual product or service providers will often have a set of terms and conditions relating to their particular product or service.

These will cover, among other items:

- Pricing policy
- Payment conditions
- Inclusions
- Exclusions
- Any restrictions or limitations



Slide 177

Slide No	Trainer Notes
177.	Class Activity – Discuss terms and conditions • What is the purpose of each of these terms and conditions? • What are examples / stipulations of each of these terms and conditions?

Slide

Explain specific details

Limitations

Particular products may have stated or self evident limitations.

- What are examples of limitations that are imposed by travel and tourism companies?



Slide 178

Slide No

Trainer Notes

178.

Class Activity – Discuss limitations

- Discuss question in the slide.

Slide

Explain specific details

Non operation of the product – tour cancellation

Whenever you book a scheduled departure of a tour there is always the risk that if the minimum numbers for that particular tour departure is not achieved, that the tour operator may elect to cancel the tour.

- What options are available to you?
- What compensation can you seek?
- When is compensation not provided?



COMPLETE ACTIVITY 16

Slide 179

Slide No	Trainer Notes
179.	Class Activity – Discuss cancellation of tours & Activity • Discuss question in the slide • Complete Activity 16.

Recommended training equipment

Access to Global Distribution Systems:

- Travelport (Galileo, & Apollo)
- Travelport (Worldspan)
- Amadeus
- Sabre
- Booking conditions
- Computer and internet access.

Computerised systems

Customer information recording forms

Examples of travel documentation

Examples of industry statistics

Examples of information relating to different tourism businesses

- Transportation
- Airlines
- Cruise operators
- Railway operators
- Bus lines
- Car rental businesses
- Limousine hire
- Taxis
- Travel insurance providers
- Finance providers
- Currency exchange
- Conference and similar venues
- Interpreters
- Hotels and motels
- Guest houses
- Bed and breakfasts
- Caravan parks and camping grounds
- Resorts
- Time share properties

- Apartments, villas and cottages
- Conference and exhibition centres
- Museums and galleries
- National parks, wildlife parks and gardens
- Theme parks
- Heritage sites and centres
- Sport and activity centres
- Aquarium and zoos
- Tour Operators
- Inbound Tour Wholesaler
- Outbound Tour Wholesaler
- Retail Travel Agents
- Local, regional and national information services
- Ministries of Tourism
- Tourism Boards.

Examples of types of information

- Destination information
- Local community information
- Tours
- Attractions
- Activities
- History
- Geographical features
- Local customs and culture
- Climate
- Accommodation
- Amenities and services.

Examples of different information formats

- Brochures, flyers and pamphlets
- Product manuals
- Supplier information and sales kits
- Confidential and general industry tariffs
- Preferred contracts or agreements
- Clue cards
- Fare sheets

- Industry publications, advices and notices
- Videos
- Posters
- Timetables
- Atlases and maps
- Travel literature
- Travel Guides
- Newspapers and magazines
- Internal databases
- Online product training modules.

Final contracts / quotations

Formal quotation templates

Industry codes:

- Airport codes
- Airline codes
- Tour codes
- Room types
- Service codes.

Manual filing systems

Policies and procedures

Quotation examples

Terms and conditions including:

- Travel Agent Terms and Conditions
- Supplier Terms and Conditions
- Product or service provider terms and conditions.

Instructions for Trainers for using PowerPoint – Presenter View

Connect your laptop or computer to your projector equipment as per manufacturers' instructions.

In PowerPoint, on the **Slide Show** menu, click **Set up Show**.

Under Multiple monitors, select the Show Presenter View check box.

In the **Display slide show** on list, click the monitor you want the slide show presentation to appear on.

Source: <http://office.microsoft.com>

Note:

In Presenter View:

You see your notes and have full control of the presentation

Your trainees only see the slide projected on to the screen

More Information

You can obtain more information on how to use PowerPoint from the Microsoft Online Help Centre, available at:

<http://office.microsoft.com/training/training.aspx?AssetID=RC011298761033>

Note Regarding Currency of URLs

Please note that where references have been made to URLs in these training resources trainers will need to verify that the resource or document referred to is still current on the internet. Trainers should endeavour, where possible, to source similar alternative examples of material where it is found that either the website or the document in question is no longer available online.

Appendix – ASEAN acronyms

AADCP	ASEAN – Australia Development Cooperation Program
ACCSTP	ASEAN Common Competency Standards for Tourism Professionals
AEC	ASEAN Economic Community
AMS	ASEAN Member States
ASEAN	Association of Southeast Asian Nations
ASEC	ASEAN Secretariat
ATM	ASEAN Tourism Ministers
ATPMC	ASEAN Tourism Professionals Monitoring Committee
ATPRS	ASEAN Tourism Professional Registration System
ATFTMD	ASEAN Task Force on Tourism Manpower Development
CATC	Common ASEAN Tourism Curriculum
MRA	Mutual Recognition Arrangement
MTCO	Mekong Tourism Coordinating office
NTO	National Tourism Organisation
NTPB	National Tourism Professional Board
RQFSRS	Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System
TPCB	Tourism Professional Certification Board

